

4 Web Search APIs, Tested Live on 3 Agent Use Cases

You.com, Tavily, Exa and Parallel, compared live on 30 queries: 10 each for GTM, insurance and finance agents, three of the most common use cases for web search APIs.



Pallavi Singla

YOU.COM · TAVILY · EXA · PARALLEL

Web search for live agents

30
live queries

3
agent use cases

4
search APIs

SUMMARY

Results at a glance

You.com is the fastest search API we tested, and the most dependable at returning something fresh. You.com leads on freshness, reliability and search-only speed. Parallel leads accuracy with You.com a close second and tied with Parallel on fully correct queries.

Overall scorecard — 30 queries, 3 use cases, 4 search APIs

GTM, Insurance and Finance, 10 agent-style search calls each (real-time to 1-year windows). Final run, Oct 8 2026.

Cell colour = rank on that row: best 2nd 3rd worst

	You.com	Tavily	Exa	Parallel
QUALITY				
Accuracy score (% of max, 30 queries × 3 repeats)	63%	51%	53%	67%
Queries fully correct in all 3 repeats	57%	37%	50%	57%
Precision@5 (on-topic share of top 5)	37%	26%	40%	26%
FRESHNESS				
Results dated inside the query's window	59%	37%	44%	29%
Newest relevant result, age (median, hours)	4.1 h	11.9 h	8.2 h	16.6 h
RELIABILITY				
Empty responses (of 90 calls)	0	27	12	3
Failed calls: errors, timeouts (of 90)	0	0	0	0
SPEED				
Latency p50, client (ms)	593	1,864	1,106	2,038
Latency p95, client (ms)	804	3,305	3,997	4,117
Latency p50, server-reported (ms)	379	1,650	831	n/a
COST				
Search cost per correct answer	\$0.026	\$0.016	\$0.012	\$0.008

Each query is written the way an AI agent calls web search: an upstream task, the search call the agent sends, its parameters, and what the agent needs back. Every use case has at least 4 real-time queries; the rest use 24-hour, 48-hour or 7-day windows. Searches run in promptfoo (3 runs per query, client-side timing). Answers were written and graded from each provider's saved results, using the published SimpleQA rubric and FreshQA strict rules.

RECOMMENDATION

My analysis: which provider fits which agent

If your agent...	Pick	Why (from this test)
Answers inside a live turn (voice, chat, alerts)	You.com	fastest at both p50 and p95, freshest results, never returns empty
Does deep research where seconds don't matter	Parallel	highest Finance accuracy; found the release pages and the jobless-claims release that others missed
Needs the most on-topic top 5 for semantic or long-tail queries	Exa	best precision@5 in GTM and Insurance; best Insurance accuracy
Looks up docs or how-to answers	Tavily	best GTM accuracy; correct on the config-docs query

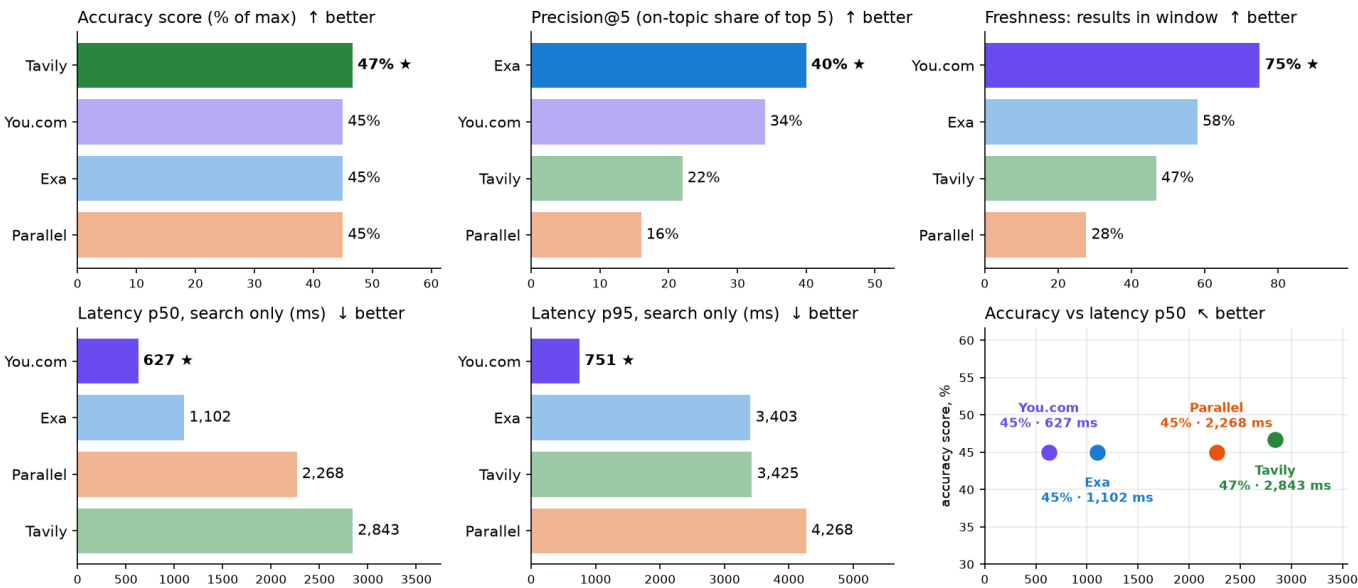
BY USE CASE

Key metrics by all three use cases among all four providers

GTM agent

- 1
- Web search for a developer-signal agent that needs real-time to 7-day signals. Agent job is to find fresh developer and company buying signals for Apache Iggy / streaming infra; output a ranked list of signals with URL, date, who and the pain quoted.

GTM — all providers, ranked best to worst per metric



You.com for real-time signal monitoring; Parallel or Tavily for release and docs lookups.

- You.com is best fit for fresh-signal sweeps an agent re-runs every few minutes. Examples are new mentions of a project, today's funding rounds, and new issues or activity. You.com had the freshest results, no empty responses, low latency, and was the only provider to surface the new Iggy developers activity.

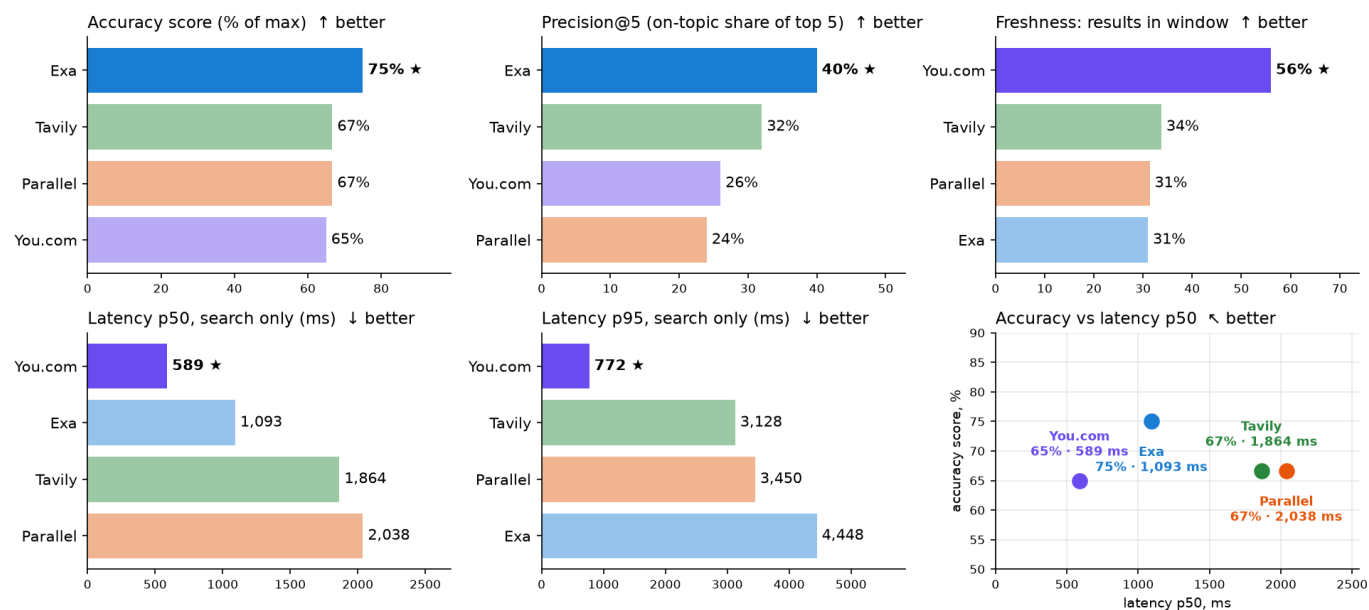
- **Parallel was the only one to find out** lggy release pages and changelog lookups, and Tavily was the only one to find out coding related Config-doc answers.

Insurance agent

2

Web search for a voice and claims agent that must know live catastrophe status mid-call. For example: Liberate-style voice agents for P&C insurers (quote, bind, first notice of loss during a live storm).

Insurance — all providers, ranked best to worst per metric



Bars sorted best → worst; ★ = best. Latency = client wall-clock, search only, run 1 (first time each query sent). Freshness = share of results dated inside the query's window. 10 queries per use case.

You.com for in-call lookups; Exa for background claims checks.

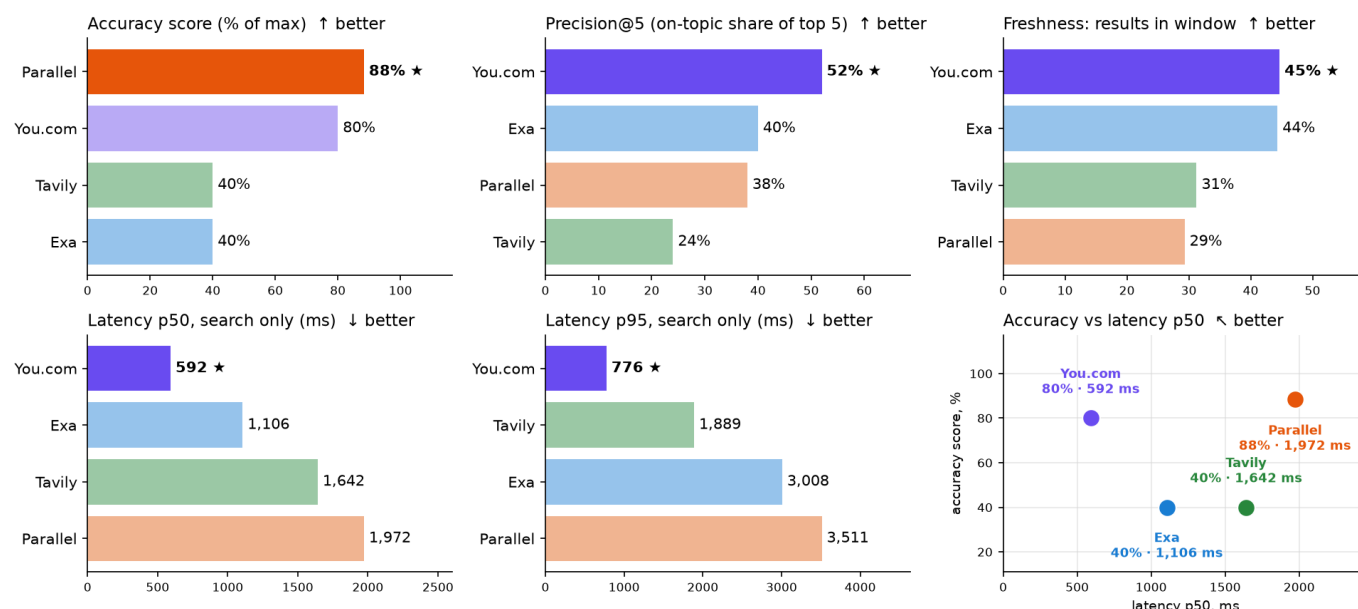
- **You.com is best fit for voice and chat agents that must answer within the caller's turn.** You.com had a lowest latency with every call under 1 s, and the freshest results. It was correct on the live recent advisory verdict, new declaration or new regulations.
- **Exa** was the only provider right on both the county warnings and the live wind speed, where You.com returned a cached weather page. That makes Exa the better fit for claims validation that can take a few seconds if both providers are used together.
- **However,** None of the four found the Underwriting-critical regulator notices such as active Citizens binding suspension that needed a direct government source feed.

Finance agent

3

Web search for an analyst agent that needs exact, current numbers with primary-source citations. It's job is to answer analyst questions with exact, current numbers and a primary-source citation.

Finance — all providers, ranked best to worst per metric



You.com for real-time market Q&A; Parallel for deep research.

- You.com is best fit for analyst copilots answering live market and filing questions.** You.com was right on prices on stocks, the 10-year yield, Bitcoins, current M&A deals, and the JPMorgan timed events. It had the best precision latency, and the freshest results.
- Parallel** was the only provider to find out the un-employment claims on (the weekly count of people newly filing for jobless benefits). It's the pick for batch research or due diligence, where about 2 s per call is fine. Tavily returned nothing on the domain-filtered dol.gov, federalreserve.gov and sec.gov queries.

EVIDENCE

Per query: what was asked, the right answer, and what each API returned

1

GTM agent · per question

What each API returned for the GTM queries

You.com wins when the agent asks what's new. It was the only API to surface today's Apache Iggy activity (G3), and it was also right on this week's funding rounds and agent-memory posts (G8, G9). **Parallel wins when the agent needs the official page**, such as a project's release notes (G4, G6). **Tavily wins on documentation lookups**, such as Kafka's consumer settings (G5). For a GTM agent that watches for fresh buying signals, You.com is the better fit. An agent that mostly looks up release notes or docs is better served by Parallel or Tavily.

GTM — what each API returned, per question

Each cell: the result the answer relied on (else the top result) exactly as returned — domain · published date, then title and its rank. Grey line = grader's verdict.

Colour = accuracy across 3 repeats (search + content run):

correct in all 3 repeats

partly correct, or correct in only some repeats

wrong or missed

Where the true answer is NONE (nothing happened), an empty result counts as correct.

What the rep asks		You.com	Tavily	Exa	Parallel
Correct answer (key)		Freshness (results in window): 75% Accuracy score: 45%	Freshness (results in window): 47% Accuracy score: 47%	Freshness (results in window): 58% Accuracy score: 45%	Freshness (results in window): 28% Accuracy score: 45%
G1	Who is hitting Kafka latency problems right now?	Kafka lag issue opened in last 6h github.com · 2026-10-07 "[Blueprint] kafka-consumer-lag-sentinel - PR..." #1/10 why: Issues from Oct 7 (outside 6h)	0 results returned why: Empty — no results	github.com · 2026-10-08 "Issues · NousResearch/hermes-agent · GitHub" #1/9 why: Unrelated repo issue-list pages	github.com · no date "GitHub - vforonelkafka-lag-lab: A Kafka consumer..." #1/9 why: Undated Kafka lag tool repos
G2	Anything new at Confluent today?	Oct 8 ATO interview, Confluent VP confluent.safebase.us · 2026-10-07 "Confluent Trust Center Powered by SafeBase" #1/10 why: Keyword noise, no Confluent news	allthingsopen.org · 2026-10-08 "You don't have an AI strategy without a data..." #5/8 why: Hit in 2 of 3 runs (ATO Oct 8)	allthingsopen.org · no date "You don't have an AI strategy without a data" #3/10 why: ATO Oct 8 interview with VP	confluent.io · no date "News, Press Releases, and Media Coverage [...]" #1/3 why: Undated newsroom, IBM deal page
G3	Any new mentions of Apache Iggy?	Iggy repo issues/PRs from last 24h github.com · 2026-10-08 "Partition replica stuck after rolling crash..." #1/10 why: Dated apache/iggy issues (Oct 8)	reddit.com · no date "Rust talks at P99 CONF (free, virtual)" #1/8 why: Undated Reddit post, noise	thedroptimes.com · no date "News Roundup TheDropTimes" #1/10 why: Unrelated Apache pages	iggy.apache.org · no date "Hyper-Efficient Message Streaming written in Rust..." #1/4 why: Undated landing and docs pages
G4	What's in Iggy's latest release?	server-0.9.0 (Sep 18) github.com · 2026-10-08 "Issue · apache/iggy" #1/10 why: Iggy issues, no release page	0 results returned why: Empty — no results	github.com · 2026-10-08 "Issues · apache/incubator-kie-issues · GitHub" #1/10 why: Other Apache projects' issue lists	github.com · no date "Releases · apache/iggy · GitHub" #2/6 why: server-0.9.0 release page (Sep 18)
G5	What's the official fix for consumer lag?	Official doc URL, both settings docs.confluent.io · 2026-09-09 "Monitor Consumer Lag in Confluent Platform [...]" #1/10 why: Official docs, settings text cut off	docs.confluent.io · 2026-09-15 "Salesforce Bulk API 2.0 Sink Connector for..." #3/10 why: Confluent docs, both settings	kafka.apache.org · 2026-05-22 "Consumer and Share Consumer Configs Apache Kafka" #1/10 why: Kafka docs, only fetch.min.bytes	docs.confluent.io · no date "Consumer Metrics" #1/10 why: Docs; max.poll.records not described
G6	What's the latest NATS server release?	v2.15.1-RC.2 (Oct 6) / v2.15.0 github.com · 2026-10-05 "Run NATS JetStream as the B.U.N.N.Y. message bus..." #1/10 why: nats-server issues, no release	github.com · 2026-10-01 "Releases · coder/coder · GitHub" #1/9 why: Other projects' release pages	github.com · 2026-10-06 "Issues · nats-io/nats-server · GitHub" #1/10 why: nats-io issue lists, no release	github.com · no date "Releases: nats-io/nats-server · GitHub" #1/9 why: v2.15.1-RC.2 and v2.15.0
G7	Is Confluent Cloud having an incident?	No active incident status.confluent.cloud · no date "Confluent Cloud Status" #1/2 why: No incident; Sep 21 page is stale	0 results returned why: Empty — no results	0 results returned why: Empty — no results	status.confluent.cloud · no date "Incident History - Confluent Cloud Status" #1/1 why: Incident history header only
G8	Which AI-agent infrastructure startups just raised?	Agent/data-infra raise in last 48h techstartups.com · 2026-10-08 "Startup Funding News Today, October 8, 2026..." #2/10 why: Manus \$500M+ (Oct 8)	htgf.de · 2026-10-08 "TODAY Secures €2.8M to scale compliant AI agents..." #3/9 why: TODAY €2.8M, Monid \$7.7M	dealroom.co · no date "Ampersand raises \$15M to connect AI agents with..." #1/10 why: 5 in-window raises incl. Rein \$25M	dealroom.co · 2026-10-08 "Rein Security raises \$25M to secure enterprise AI..." #2/5 why: Rein \$25M Series A (Oct 8)
G9	What's new this week on memory for AI agents?	Agent-memory articles this week arize.com · 2026-10-02 "AI memory: types, architecture, and how memory..." #2/10 why: Arize, Ability.ai, dev.to (Oct 2-6)	ability.ai · 2026-10-06 "AI agent durability: why humans are the ultimate..." #1/6 why: Ability.ai, Wenlan, Elgent (Oct 4-7)	likeone.ai · 2026-10-02 "Persistent Memory for AI Agents (2026) Like One" #1/10 why: Like One, Databricks, arXiv (Oct 2-6)	arxiv.org · no date "Memory for Autonomous LLM Agents: Mechanisms..." #1/6 why: On-topic but nothing dated in window
G10	Any Redpanda vs Kafka latency benchmarks?	In-window Redpanda vs Kafka p99 data automq.com · 2026-05-07 "Redpanda vs Kafka vs AutoMQ: Latency & Cost..." #1/10 why: Medium p99.99 numbers, no runner	robustmq.com · 2026-03-28 "RobustMQ vs Redpanda..." #1/10 why: Vendor pages, no benchmark	computingforgeeks.com · 2026-04-08 "Kafka vs Redpanda: Real Benchmarks on Identical..." #1/10 why: 5 dated benchmarks, no p99 numbers	computingforgeeks.com · 2026-04-08 "Kafka vs Redpanda: Real Benchmarks on Identical..." #1/8 why: ComputingForGeeks, avg latency only

2

Insurance agent · per question

What each API returned for the Insurance queries

You.com returned the latest NHC hurricane advisory (I2), but for current wind speed it returned a cached weather page instead of a live reading (I4). Exa was the only API to get both the live wind speed and both county warnings (I3, I4), which is why it leads Insurance accuracy. No API found the Citizens binding suspension (I1), so an insurance agent still needs a direct check of carrier and regulator pages.

Insurance — what each API returned, per query

Each cell: the result the answer relied on (else the top result) exactly as returned — domain · published date, then title and its rank. Grey line = grader's verdict.

Colour = accuracy across 3 repeats (search + content run):

correct in all 3 repeats

partly correct, or correct in only some repeats

wrong or missed

Where the true answer is NONE (nothing happened), an empty result counts as correct.

Search call (query)		Correct answer (key)	You.com Freshness (results in window): 56% Accuracy score: 65%	Tavily Freshness (results in window): 34% Accuracy score: 67%	Exa Freshness (results in window): 31% Accuracy score: 75%	Parallel Freshness (results in window): 31% Accuracy score: 67%
11	Citizens Property Insurance binding suspension Florida	YES, statewide, eff. Oct 7 11:05am	citizensfla.com · no date "Citizens Property Insurance Corporation Board of..." #1/10 why: Old 2020-23 minutes; missed suspension	0 results returned why: Empty — no results	0 results returned why: Empty — no results	securesupport.citize... · no date "What is Citizens hurricane or tropical storm..." #1/5 why: Evergreen rule + Helene 2024; missed
12	Hurricane Isaias latest advisory NHC	Advisory #8, 85 mph, 23.7N 90.2W	wdam.com · 2026-10-08 "10 AM NHC Advisory: Hurricane Isaias expected to..." #2/10 why: Adv #8 by time: 75 kt, 23.7N 90.2W	nhc.noaa.gov · 2026-10-08 "Hurricane Isaias Public Advisory" #1/9 why: Stale: Adv #6A (1 AM CDT)	nhc.noaa.gov · no date "US Watch/Warning - National Hurricane Center..." #1/10 why: Advisory #8, 75 kt (~85 mph)	wjhg.com · 2026-10-08 "HURRICANE ISAIAS Hurricane and storm surge..." #3/9 why: 10 AM adv, 75 kt; stale in 1 of 3 runs
13	hurricane warning Escambia County Florida active	Hurricane + Storm Surge Warning	pnj.com · 2026-10-08 "Recap: Hurricane warning issued for Escambia..." #3/10 why: Hurricane Warning only; no surge	northescambia.com · 2026-10-08 "Hurricane Warning In Effect For The Gulf Coast ..." #1/8 why: Hurricane Warning only; no surge	pensacola.newswk.com · 2026-10-08 "Hurricane Warning: Escambia Coastal" #1/10 why: Hurricane + Surge Warnings, Oct 7	pnj.com · 2026-10-07 "Tropical Storm Isaias live updates for Pensacola..." #1/10 why: Hurricane Warning only; no surge
14	Pensacola weather wind speed	~10 mph NE, KPNS obs 15:50Z	forecast.weather.gov · 2026-10-07 "National Weather Service" #1/10 why: Stale cached weather pages (Aug/Feb)	world-weather.info · 2026-10-07 "Weather in Pensacola in October 2026 (Florida)" #1/9 why: Current obs 13 mph in 2 of 3 runs	exa.ai · 2026-10-08 "Pensacola, Florida, United States Weather Today..." #1/10 why: 13 mph NE, 11am (model estimate)	weather.com · no date "Weather for Pensacola, Florida, United States" #1/10 why: Forecasts + 5-hr-hold Windfinder report
15	Baldwin County Alabama evacuation order Isaias	NONE (voluntary only)	fox10tv.com · 2026-10-07 "Baldwin County declares local state of emergency..." #1/10 why: No mandatory order; voluntary only	al.com · 2026-10-07 "Gulf Shores and Orange Beach urge visitors to..." #1/10 why: No mandatory order; voluntary only	fox10tv.com · 2026-10-07 "Baldwin County declares local state of emergency..." #1/10 why: No mandatory order; voluntary only	al.com · 2026-10-07 "Mobile and Baldwin counties urge hurricane..." #4/9 why: No mandatory order; voluntary urged
16	FEMA disaster declaration Hurricane Isaias 2026	NONE yet (no 2026 FEMA decl.)	pnj.com · 2026-10-07 "What a Florida state of emergency means with..." #1/10 why: None yet; FL state emergency only	blogs.usfcr.com · 2026-10-07 "Isaias 2026: What Gulf Coast Contractors Should..." #3/10 why: None yet; off-target results	nhc.noaa.gov · 2026-10-08 "(no title)" #1/10 why: None yet; NHC advisories only	fema.gov · 2026-10-07 "Press Releases" #5/6 why: None yet; FEMA releases Oct 7 lack it
17	Florida OIR OR Alabama DOI emergency order Isaias insurance	NONE (no OIR/DOI order)	insurancejournal.com · 2026-10-08 "Two Past Hurricanes, OIR Data Give Idea of What..." #1/10 why: No regulator order found	0 results returned why: Empty — no results	pubt.io · 2026-10-07 "Florida Office of Insurance Regulation (via..." #1/10 why: No order; OIR notice + ALDOI release	floir.gov · no date "Home [floir.gov]" #3/10 why: No order; old Helene order flagged
18	governor state of emergency Hurricane Isaias	FL EO 26-202 (Oct 6) + AL (Oct 7)	wesh.com · 2026-10-08 "Gov. DeSantis declares state of emergency for 25..." #1/10 why: FL EO 26-202 Oct 6; AL without date	wesh.com · 2026-10-08 "State of emergency declared in Florida for..." #1/10 why: FL Oct 6 + AL 40 counties Oct 7	figov.com · 2026-10-07 "#2026-202 re: Emergency Management - Tropical..." #1/10 why: FL EO 26-202 only; AL missing	wrtv.com · 2026-10-07 "Hurricane Isaias prompts states of emergency in..." #1/10 why: AL Oct 7 + FL EO 26-202 Oct 6
19	Texas hail storm reports	NONE (no TX hail in 24h)	spc.noaa.gov · no date "JUNE 1998 277 E D W A R D S A N D T H O M P S O N" #1/2 why: No Texas hail reports in results	0 results returned why: Empty — no results	0 results returned why: Empty — no results	0 results returned why: Empty — no results
110	NHTSA recall 2024 Toyota RAV4	3 recalls: 24V911, 25V595, 25V744	static.nhtsa.gov · 2026-03-24 "U.S. Department of Transportation National..." #2/10 why: Only 26V179 (RAV4 Hybrid)	static.nhtsa.gov · 2026-05-23 "Part 573 Safety Recall Report 26V179" #1/8 why: 25V744, 25V595, 26V179; no 24V911	static.nhtsa.gov · no date "[PDF] Part 573 Safety Recall Report 26V179 NHTSA" #1/2 why: No RAV4 recall found	nhtsa.gov · 2025-10-30 "Vehicle Detail Search - 2024 TOYOTA RAV4 HYBRID..." #2/8 why: 25V744 + 26V179; run 2 only 26V179

3

Finance agent · per question

What each API returned for the Finance queries

You.com and Parallel are the two APIs that reliably answered live market and filing questions. Both got the NVDA price, the 10-year yield, Bitcoin, the Fed minutes, the Stryker 8-K and the JPMorgan earnings date (F1-F3, F6, F8, F10). Parallel edges ahead because it was the only API to find the right week's jobless-claims report (F5). You.com's one miss on live prices was a WTI oil quote that was four hours old (F4). Tavily and Exa trail at 0.80. Tavily returned nothing on queries limited to government sites (dol.gov, federalreserve.gov, sec.gov), and Exa mostly returned stale prices (F1, F2, F4).

Finance — what each API returned, per query

Each cell: the result the answer relied on (else the top result) exactly as returned — domain · published date, then title and its rank. Grey line = grader's verdict.
Colour = accuracy across 3 repeats (search + content run): correct in all 3 repeats partly correct, or correct in only some repeats wrong or missed
Where the true answer is NONE (nothing happened), an empty result counts as correct.

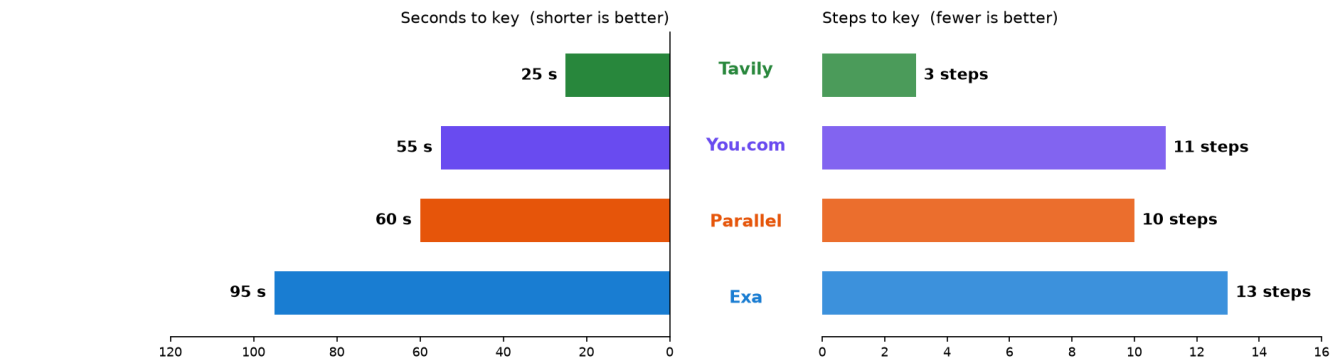
Search call (query)		Correct answer (key)	You.com	Tavily	Exa	Parallel
			Freshness (results in window): 45% Accuracy score: 80%	Freshness (results in window): 31% Accuracy score: 40%	Freshness (results in window): 44% Accuracy score: 40%	Freshness (results in window): 29% Accuracy score: 88%
F1	NVDA stock price	\$235.58-235.60 (12:24-12:35 ET)	finance.yahoo.com · 2026-10-07 "NVIDIA Corporation (NVDA) Stock Price, News..." #1/10 why: \$235.72, no intraday time	pluang.com · 2026-10-08 "Nvidia Corp (NVDA) Stock Price Today: \$235.34 [...]" #2/7 why: \$235.22 at 12:05 ET (1 repeat stale)	exa.ai · 2026-10-07 "NVIDIA Corp (NVDA) Closed at \$237.47 (-0.74%) [...]" #1/10 why: Oct 7 close \$237.47 (stale)	investor.nvidia.com · 2026-10-08 "NVIDIA Corporation - Stock Quote & Chart" #3/10 why: \$235.25 at 12:21 ET
F2	US 10-year Treasury yield	5.265-5.269% (12:25-12:36 ET)	cnbc.com · 2026-10-08 "10-year Treasury yield is little changed as Fed's..." #4/10 why: 5.27-5.28% (TE; CNBC 5.284%)	binance.com · no date "U.S. 10-year Treasury yield rises to the highest..." #1/3 why: Nothing current — old 2026 posts	home.treasury.gov · no date "Daily Treasury Rates U.S. Department of the..." #1/10 why: 5.322% from 5:19 AM (morning high)	tradingeconomics.com · no date "US 10 Year Treasury Note Yield - Quote - Chart" #3/8 why: 5.273% (CNBC), TE 5.28%
F3	BTC USD price	\$81,169-81,376 (Coinbase spot)	coingecko.com · 2026-10-08 "Bitcoin Price: BTC/USD Live Price Chart, Market..." #3/10 why: \$81,306.68 (CoinGecko)	finance.yahoo.com · 2026-10-08 "Bitcoin USD (BTC-USD) Interactive Price Chart [...]" #1/4 why: \$81,027.80 at 15:57 UTC	benzinga.com · 2026-10-08 "Bitcoin, Ethereum, XRP, Dogecoin Tumble as..." #1/10 why: Only dated quotes —\$82.6-83.0k	coinmarketcap.com · no date "Bitcoin price today, BTC to USD live price,..." #2/9 why: \$81,062.89 (CMC), \$81,247.90
F4	WTI crude oil price	\$90.95-91.04 (12:20-12:31 ET)	investing.com · 2026-10-08 "Crude Oil Futures Price Today (WTI) [...]" #1/10 why: \$92.63 at 8:18 ET (4h stale)	cnbc.com · 2026-10-08 "Oil prices today: Brent, WTI gain on Middle East..." #5/7 why: \$91.58 Asian session (repeats differ)	finance.yahoo.com · no date "Crude Oil Nov 26 (CL=F) Stock Price, News, Quote..." #1/10 why: \$92.29 at 10:43 ET (stale)	oilprice.com · no date "WTI Crude Oil Price Charts Oilprice.com" #1/7 why: \$90.91 (repeats differ, stale)
F5	initial jobless claims weekly report	197,000 (wk ending Oct 3)	dol.gov · no date "News Releases U.S. Department of Labor" #1/2 why: Only a 2009-10 claims archive	0 results returned why: Empty — no results	0 results returned why: Empty — no results	dol.gov · no date "News Release" #1/1 why: 197,000, wk ending Oct 3 (DOL PDF)
F6	FOMC minutes	Sep 15-16 minutes, out Oct 7 2pm ET	federalreserve.gov · 2026-10-07 "FOMC Minutes, September 15-16, 2026" #2/10 why: Sep 15-16 minutes, Oct 7 2pm ET	0 results returned why: Empty — no results	federalreserve.gov · no date "The Fed - Monetary Policy: Federal Reserve" #1/10 why: Sep 15-16 minutes, Oct 7 2pm ET	federalreserve.gov · 2026-10-07 "Federal Reserve Board - Minutes of the Federal..." #3/4 why: Date and link, no key points
F7	definitive agreement to acquire billion	Viatriis-Pacira \$1.65B; Boots \$8.9B	seniorshousingbusine... · 2026-10-07 "BDT & MSD to Acquire Sunrise Senior Living for \$1B" #1/10 why: Viatriis-Pacira \$1.65B, plus RXO	linkedin.com · no date "C.H. Robinson's \$5.8 Billion Agreement to Acquire..." #1/10 why: Schneider-PTC (Oct 5, out of window)	mckesson.com · no date "CD&R and McKesson Corporation Sign Agreement to..." #1/10 why: Boots \$8.9B, Viatriis-Pacira	marketscreener.com · no date "Dassault Systèmes SE signed a definitive..." #1/2 why: Out-of-window deals; repeats vary
F8	Stryker 8-K item 5.02	Oct 6 8-K: Lobo to step down as CEO	sec.gov · 2026-10-06 "EDGAR Filing Documents for 0001193125-26-414956" #1/10 why: Stryker Oct 6 8-K, index link	0 results returned why: Empty — no results	sec.gov · 2026-10-05 "Form 8-K" #1/10 why: Nothing — other issuers' 8-Ks	sec.gov · no date "8-K - SEC.gov" #2/9 why: Stryker 8-K text: Lobo to Exec Chair
F9	Chilwa Minerals IPO price per share	\$5.60 per ADS (CHWM, Oct 1)	ca.investing.com · 2026-10-01 "Chilwa Minerals prices \$3.5M Nasdaq ADS offering..." #1/10 why: \$5.60 per ADS, CHWM	247wallst.com · 2026-10-02 "Chilwa Minerals (CHWM) prices Nasdaq IPO at \$5.60..." #1/7 why: \$5.60/share, 625,000 shares	globenewswire.com · 2026-10-02 "Chilwa Announces Closing of US\$3.5 Million..." #1/10 why: \$5.60 per ADS (424B1)	marketbeat.com · no date "Chilwa Minerals (CHWM) Stock Price, News &..." #1/9 why: \$5.60 (one source says \$5.00)
F10	JPMorgan third quarter 2026 earnings release date	Tue Oct 13, 2026 (call 8:30 ET)	marketbeat.com · 2026-10-06 "JPMorgan Chase & Co. (JPM) Projected to Announce..." #1/10 why: Oct 13, before open, call 8:30	zacks.com · 2026-10-08 "JPMorgan's Shares Before Q3 Earnings: Buy Now or..." #1/8 why: Oct 13 (one repeat: nothing)	marketbeat.com · 2026-10-13 "JPMorgan Chase & Co. Q3 2026 Earnings Report" #1/10 why: Oct 13, before open, call 8:30	seekingalpha.com · 2026-10-07 "JPMorgan (JPM) Q3 Earnings Preview: Can Strong..." #1/8 why: Oct 13, ~7:00 release, 8:30 call

DEVELOPER EXPERIENCE

Setup & friction: summary

Time and steps to activation — sign-in to a copied API key

Left: seconds from sign-in to copying the key (screen recordings). Right: steps in between, i.e. each screen or click the developer must get through (Scribe step count).



Tavily's step count is read from the screen recording; the others are Scribe step counts after sign-in.
Exa's 13 includes ~10 repeated clicks on Copy buttons that stay disabled until the agent setup prompt and skill are copied.

Time to activation is the seconds from signing in to copying a working API key, timed from the screen recordings. Steps to activation is the number of screens or clicks a developer must get through in between.

What stands between sign-in and the API key

Green = no friction · amber = a small extra step · red = a gate that blocks the key until completed

	You.com	Tavily	Exa	Parallel
Sign-in How the account is created	Google sign-in, first try	Google sign-in, first try	Google sign-in, first try	Google sign-in, first try
Survey / questionnaire Questions asked before you can reach the key	1 survey: 'How did you hear about us?'	1 use-case screen, skippable	2-question questionnaire: API or MCP? What are you building?	1 survey: 'Where did you hear about Parallel?'
Organization / team setup Must create a company workspace or invite teammates first	None	None	None	Required: name an organization, then a team-invite step
Agent-setup gate Must copy a coding-agent prompt or install a skill before the key can be copied	None	None (agent prompt offered, optional)	Required: copy setup prompt + 'npx skills add' before Copy key unlocks	None
Getting the key Whether a key already exists or you must create it	Create it yourself: API Keys → name → Create → copy (shown once)	Ready on the landing dashboard	Auto-created; copy unlocks last	Auto-created; under Settings → API Keys
Card required Payment card needed to start	No	No	No	No
Free credit at signup What you can spend right away	\$10 usable; \$100 advertised (+\$90 after verifying GitHub or work email)	1,000 credits / month	\$10 on setup screen, \$20 on dashboard	\$20, expires in 60 days
Spend visible in API response Remaining credit or cost per call returned with results	No, dashboard only	No, dashboard only	Yes (costDollars)	Yes (usage field)
First API call Result of the first request with the new key	200 on first try	200 on first try	200 on first try	200 on first try

Where You.com could remove friction (quick wins):

- 1. Show a ready-made default key on the first dashboard view. Tavily, Exa and Parallel all do. This saves about 30 s and brings You.com in line with the fastest.
- 2. Make the advertised credit match what's usable at signup, or move the verification step after the first call.
- 3. Return the remaining credit or the cost per call in the API response, as Exa (costDollars) and Parallel (usage) do. Today it is visible only in the dashboard.

APPENDIX

Details and deep dives

The full data for each section is online. Click a section to open it on the web page.

Detailed timed setup and friction log	OPEN ONLINE ↗
How each result was judged	OPEN ONLINE ↗
GTM agent: queries, what each API returned and metric scorecard	OPEN ONLINE ↗
Insurance agent: queries, what each API returned and metric scorecard	OPEN ONLINE ↗
Finance agent (Rogo-style): queries, what each API returned and metric scorecard	OPEN ONLINE ↗

Independent hands-on evaluation, run live on October 8, 2026. Not affiliated with or endorsed by any provider named.